Portugals Economic and Human Development: A Century of Transformation

Country	Decade	GDPpc (2011 int-$)	Life expect. (years)	Events
Central/Eastern Europe				
Hungary	1960	7,002	69.0	1968: New Economic Mechanism; limited market reforms ins
Poland	1960	5,985	68.8	
Romania	1960	3,751	67.0	1965: Ceauescu becomes leader; industrialization and la
Czechia	1970	10,615	70.2	1977: Charter 77; dissident manifesto signed by Havel an
Hungary	1970	9,108	69.4	
Poland	1970	8,734	70.5	1970: Baltic coast strikes; workers protest food prices;
Romania	1970	5,808	69.1	1977: Vrancea earthquake devastates Bucharest; large rec
Czechia	1980	12,902	71.0	1989: Velvet Revolution (November); peaceful end of comm
Hungary	1980	10,597	69.3	1989: Round-table talks; Republic of Hungary proclaimed
Poland	1980	8,954	70.9	1980: Solidarity trade union founded; 10 million members. 1981: Martial law declared (13 December); Solidarity ban. 1989: Round Table talks; first partially free elections
Romania	1980	6,537	69.5	1980: Austerity to repay foreign debt; severe shortages . 1989: Romanian Revolution (December); Ceauescu executed
Czechia	1990	14,340	73.1	1990: Economic transition begins; voucher privatization . 1992: Split of Czechoslovakia agreed (Velvet Divorce); e. 1993: Czechoslovakia dissolved (1 January); Czech Republ. 1997: Currency crisis and
Hungary	1990	10,319	69.9	1990: First free elections; market transition and privat. 1999: Hungary joins NATO
Poland	1990	9,436	71.9	1990: Balcerowicz Plan; shock therapy; rapid transition . 1993: Economy begins to recover; first post-communist co. 1999: Poland joins NATO
Romania	1990	5,789	69.6	1990: Market transition begins; inflation and industrial. 1999: NATO Membership Action Plan; delayed recovery afte
Czechia	2000	21,593	76.0	2004: Czech Republic joins the European Union (1 May). 2008: Global financial crisis; export-dependent economy
Hungary	2000	17,179	72.7	2004: Hungary joins the European Union (1 May). 2008: Global financial crisis; IMF-EU stand-by arrangeme
Poland	2000	15,720	74.8	2004: Poland joins the European Union (1 May); largest n. 2008: Poland is only EU country to avoid recession durin
Romania	2000	11,429	71.9	2004: Romania joins NATO. 2007: Romania joins the European Union (1 January). 2008: Global financial crisis; IMF stand-by arrangement
Czechia	2010	28,433	78.5	
Hungary	2010	22,941	75.6	2010: Orbn government; unorthodox economic policy and l
Poland	2010	24,288	77.3	
Romania	2010	19,657	74.9	
Czechia	2020	31,355	78.1	2020: COVID-19; GDP contracts ~5.8%
Hungary	2020	27,876	75.1	2020: COVID-19; GDP contracts then rebounds
Poland	2020	30,578	76.3	2020: COVID-19; GDP contracts ~2.5% (one of mildest rece
Romania	2020	25,700	74.1	2020: COVID-19; GDP contracts; later recovery led by con
Group Average:		*15,060*	*72.4*	
Focus				
Portugal	1960	6,236	65.2	1960: Industrial sector surpasses agriculture in contrib. 1960: Portugal is a founding member of EFTA (4 January S. 1961: Colonial War begins in Angola (4 February); 13-yea. 1961: Loss of Portuguese I
Portugal	1970	10,740	68.6	1972: SETENAVE shipyard established in Setbal; second m. 1972: Free trade agreement signed with the EEC (effectiv. 1973: Leica factory established in Vila Nova de Famalic. 1973: Gold and currency re
Portugal	1980	13,892	72.8	1981: Sines industrial complex and deep-water port fully. 1982: Constitutional revision; reduces military role; st. 1983: Second IMF bailout; continued fiscal and external . 1985: Treaty of Accession
Portugal	1990	19,553	74.9	1990: Privatization law enacted (April); framework for c. 1991: Autoeuropa joint venture (VW/Ford) announced; larg. 1991: Siderurgia Nacional re-privatized (Decree-Law 113/. 1991: A1 motorway Lisbon-P
Portugal	2000	24,400	77.7	2000: Lisnave Margueira closes (31 December); end of Por. 2000: GDP per capita reaches 70% of EU-12 average; unpre. 2001: Porto European Capital of Culture; Casa da Msica . 2001: Siderurgia Nacional

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Country	Decade	GDPpc (2011 int-$)	Life expect. (years)	Events
Portugal	2010	25,584	80.8	2010: Fiscal deficit reaches ~11% of GDP; sovereign bond. 2011: Troika bailout (May); EU/ECB/IMF programme of EUR . 2012: Lisbon Metro Red Line extended to Aeroporto; golde. 2013: Unemployment peaks a
Portugal	2020	27,277	81.4	2020: COVID-19 pandemic; GDP contracts sharply; tourism . 2021: EU Recovery and Resilience Plan (PRR) approved; EU. 2022: GDP recovers to pre-pandemic levels; strong post-C
Group Average:		*18,240*	*74.5*	
Post-Soviet				
Estonia	1970	13,799	70.2	
Latvia	1970	12,506	69.8	
Lithuania	1970	12,103	71.3	
Estonia	1980	16,622	69.7	1987: Phosphorite War; environmental protests become veh. 1988: Singing Revolution; mass song festivals become pol. 1989: Baltic Way; 2 million people form human chain acro
Latvia	1980	14,467	69.7	1988: Popular Front of Latvia founded; national awakenin. 1989: Baltic Way human chain; sovereignty declaration pr
Lithuania	1980	13,742	71.1	1988: Sjdis reform movement founded; national revival
Estonia	1990	14,252	68.9	1991: Re-independence of Estonia (20 August); sovereignt. 1992: New constitution; Estonian kroon introduced replac. 1994: Radical economic reforms; flat tax introduced; rap
Latvia	1990	10,470	68.2	1991: Restoration of independence (21 August) during the. 1992: Latvian rublis then lats currency reform; rapid li. 1995: Banking crisis; collapse of Banka Baltija
Lithuania	1990	10,090	70.2	1990: Act of the Re-Establishment of the State (11 March. 1991: January Events in Vilnius; independence recognized. 1993: Litas reintroduced; last Russian troops leave
Estonia	2000	21,191	72.2	2004: Estonia joins the European Union (1 May) and NATO . 2007: Estonia joins Schengen Area; cyberattacks from Rus. 2008: Global financial crisis; GDP contracts sharply aft
Latvia	2000	16,111	71.4	2004: Latvia joins the European Union (1 May) and NATO. 2008: Severe financial crisis; GDP falls about 18%; inte
Lithuania	2000	15,715	71.8	2004: Lithuania joins the European Union (1 May) and NAT. 2008: Global financial crisis; deep recession and emigra
Estonia	2010	24,512	77.2	2011: Estonia adopts the Euro (1 January); first former
Latvia	2010	21,717	74.3	2014: Latvia adopts the Euro (1 January)
Lithuania	2010	23,756	74.6	2015: Lithuania adopts the Euro (1 January)
Estonia	2020	29,609	77.8	2020: COVID-19; GDP contracts ~3%; digital infrastructur
Latvia	2020	26,471	74.2	2020: COVID-19; GDP contracts then rebounds
Lithuania	2020	30,131	74.9	2020: COVID-19; relatively mild GDP contraction
Group Average:		*18,181*	*72.1*	
Western Europe				
Belgium	1960	13,363	70.5	1960: Independence of the Belgian Congo; colonial econom
France	1960	14,367	70.7	1960: Trente Glorieuses in full swing; sustained high gr. 1962: Algerian War ends; independence granted; nearly 1 . 1968: May 1968; student and worker protests; general str
Germany	1960	14,244	70.1	1961: Berlin Wall erected (13 August); physical division
Greece	1960	6,896	71.0	1967: Military junta (Colonels regime) until 1974
Ireland	1960	8,062	70.5	
Italy	1960	12,199	70.1	1960: Economic miracle in full swing; industrialization
Spain	1960	7,165	70.4	1960: Spanish economic miracle begins; rapid industriali
Belgium	1970	19,776	72.0	1973: Oil crisis; end of postwar high-growth period
France	1970	20,828	72.8	1973: Oil crisis; end of Trente Glorieuses; growth slowd
Germany	1970	19,554	71.5	1973: Oil crisis; end of the Wirtschaftswunder; structur

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Country	Decade	GDPpc (2011 int-$)	Life expect. (years)	Events
Greece	1970	12,261	73.4	1974: Fall of the junta after Cyprus crisis; return to d
Ireland	1970	11,501	71.6	1973: Ireland joins the EEC (1 January) with the UK and . 1979: Ireland joins the European Monetary System; breaks
Italy	1970	17,514	72.7	1973: Oil crisis; Years of Lead political violence; grow
Spain	1970	12,043	73.2	1973: Oil crisis hits; end of the Spanish economic mirac. 1975: Death of Franco (20 November); transition to democ. 1977: First democratic elections since 1936; Moncloa Pac. 1978: New democratic const
Belgium	1980	24,107	74.5	
France	1980	25,022	75.2	1981: Mitterrand elected; nationalizations followed by U
Germany	1980	23,980	74.0	1989: Fall of the Berlin Wall (9 November); peaceful rev
Greece	1980	14,777	75.8	1981: Greece joins the EEC (1 January)
Ireland	1980	14,865	73.6	
Italy	1980	22,593	75.4	
Spain	1980	15,235	76.2	1986: Spain joins the EEC (1 January); same accession as
Belgium	1990	29,416	76.8	1993: Belgium becomes a federal state; Brussels is de fa. 1999: Belgium adopts the Euro; founding Eurozone member
France	1990	29,539	77.7	1999: France adopts the Euro; founding Eurozone member
Germany	1990	28,656	76.4	1990: German reunification (3 October); East and West me. 1999: Germany adopts the Euro; founding Eurozone member
Greece	1990	17,489	77.6	1999: Greece meets Euro convergence criteria later; join
Ireland	1990	24,833	75.6	1999: Ireland adopts the Euro; founding Eurozone member
Italy	1990	28,395	78.1	1992: Maastricht Treaty; Tangentopoli corruption scandal. 1999: Italy adopts the Euro; founding Eurozone member
Spain	1990	21,689	77.9	1992: Barcelona Olympics and Seville Expo; massive infra. 1999: Spain adopts the Euro; founding Eurozone member
Belgium	2000	35,898	78.9	2008: Global financial crisis; Fortis and Dexia bank res
France	2000	35,167	80.2	2008: Global financial crisis; GDP contracts; major bank
Germany	2000	36,611	78.9	2003: Agenda 2010 reforms (Hartz reforms); labour market. 2008: Global financial crisis; export-driven economy con
Greece	2000	25,533	79.1	2001: Greece adopts the Euro (1 January). 2004: Athens Olympic Games; large public infrastructure
Ireland	2000	46,399	78.6	2008: Banking collapse and property crash; EU-IMF bailou
Italy	2000	34,529	80.8	2008: Global financial crisis; prolonged stagnation and
Spain	2000	30,340	80.2	2008: Housing bubble bursts; severe economic crisis; une
Belgium	2010	39,100	81.1	
France	2010	37,297	82.4	2018: Gilets jaunes (Yellow Vests) protests; fuel tax an
Germany	2010	44,372	80.7	2015: Refugee crisis; over 1 million asylum seekers arri
Greece	2010	23,416	81.2	2010: Sovereign debt crisis; first Troika bailout. 2015: Third bailout after referendum; capital controls; . 2018: Greece exits the bailout programmes
Ireland	2010	52,404	81.5	2013: Ireland exits the EU-IMF programme. 2015: GDP jumps after large multinational inversions; GD
Italy	2010	34,361	82.8	2011: Sovereign debt crisis; technocratic Monti governme
Spain	2010	32,370	82.9	2012: Bank bailout from ESM (EUR 41 billion); Bankia nat. 2014: Recovery begins; export growth and tourism lead re
Belgium	2020	40,536	81.4	2020: COVID-19; GDP contracts sharply; early European ou
France	2020	37,741	82.2	2020: COVID-19; France imposes strict lockdowns; GDP con
Germany	2020	45,934	80.8	2020: COVID-19 pandemic; GDP contracts ~4.9%
Greece	2020	23,594	80.7	2020: COVID-19; tourism collapse; GDP contracts sharply
Ireland	2020	57,557	82.4	2020: COVID-19; GDP holds up better than GNI because of
Italy	2020	34,479	82.5	2020: COVID-19; first major European outbreak; GDP contr

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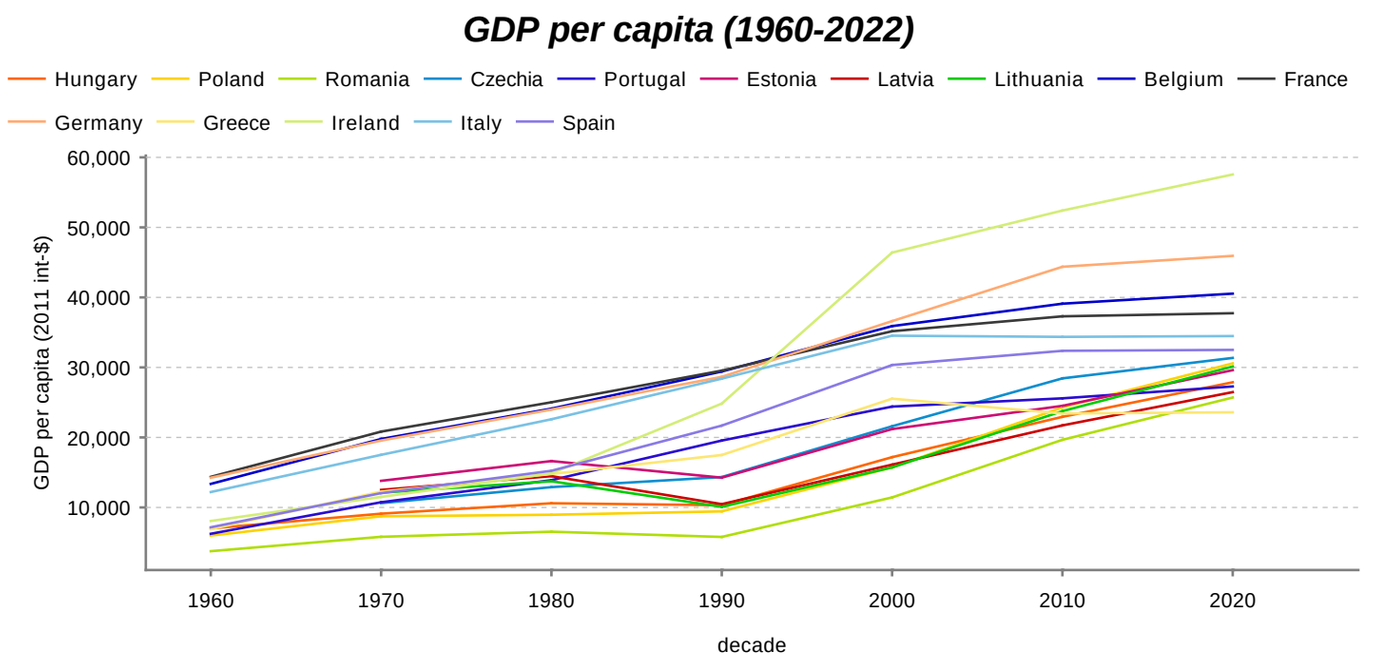
Country	Decade	GDPpc (2011 int-$)	Life expect. (years)	Events
Spain	2020	32,504	82.8	2020: COVID-19; Spain among hardest-hit EU economies; GD
Group Average:		*26,337*	*76.9*	
European Avg:		*21,308*	*74.7*	



1960 EFTA 1974 Revolution 1986 EEC 1999 euro 2011 bailout

Final note:

This report compares GDP per capita and life expectancy across European countries from 1960 to 2022, organized by country groups and grouped by decade. The period was selected because most countries have data for both indicators within this range, although coverage varies. Some countries, particularly in Central/ Eastern Europe and the Post-soviet, have incomplete data for earlier years.